

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 7 5 4
 ♥ Q J
 ♦ K Q 8 2
 ♣ 9 4 2

♠ J 10 9
 ♥ K 10 7 3
 ♦ A J 10
 ♣ A Q 5



♠ 6 2
 ♥ 9 4 2
 ♦ 9 7 4 3
 ♣ K J 8 3

♠ K Q 8 3
 ♥ A 8 6 5
 ♦ 6 5
 ♣ 10 7 6

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	1NT	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	3 ♥
All Pass			
3 ♥ by North			
Lead: ♠ 6			

The bidding has been as shown.

You treat partner's 1NT Overcall the same as a 1NT Opening. You use Stayman and bid 2 ♣. Partner replies 2 ♥. What is your next bid?

You have 9 points, an invitational strength hand. You bid 3 ♥, inviting partner to go to game with a maximum. He declines your invitation.

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 4
 ♥ K Q J
 ♦ A Q 9 5
 ♣ K 9 7 2

♠ K 7 5 3 2

♥ A 2

♦ J 6 2

♣ A 8 4



♠ A J 9

♥ 10 9 4

♦ K 3

♣ Q J 10 6 3

♠ Q 10 6

♥ 8 7 6 5 3

♦ 10 8 7 4

♣ 5

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

2 ♣

Pass

2 ♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♠ 10

The bidding has been as shown.

You have a sound 2-level overcall. You bid 2 ♣ and partner replies 2 ♠. What is your next bid?

Partner's cue-bid obviously forces you to bid.

Partner's hand might be very distributional, but rather than just sticking to ♣s you suggest with 2NT. This guarantees you have ♠s stopped. Partner likes your suggestion and bids 3NT.

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 7 6
♥ K 6 3
♦ 10 5 4
♣ A K 9 3

♠ K Q J 10 5

♥ Q 10 7

♦ A J 3

♣ 8 7



♠ 9 4 2
♥ 8 5 4 2
♦ 8 6 2
♣ 5 4 2

♠ 8 3

♥ A J 9

♦ K Q 9 7

♣ Q J 10 6

The bidding has been as shown.

Balanced hand, poor support for partner's suit, stoppers in their suit and 13 points. You couldn't get a better hand to jump to 2NT. Partner takes you to 3NT.

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	1 ♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♣K			

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 10
 ♥ Q 10 7
 ♦ A 7 5
 ♣ K Q 10 9

♠ K 6 5

♥ A 9 6 2

♦ 3

♣ A J 8 5 3



♠ 8 3

♥ K 8 5

♦ K Q 10 9 6 4

♣ 7 2

♠ Q 9 7 4 2

♥ J 4 3

♦ J 8 2

♣ 6 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	2 ♦	Pass
2NT	Pass	3 ♥	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♣5			

The bidding has been as shown.

With a good 6-card suit and 10 points you make a Weak Jump Overcall to 2 ♦. Partner says 2NT.

The 2NT bid is a standard response to a Weak 2-bid. It asks for the identification of any outside high-card if the Weak 2-bidder has more than a minimum. Here you are in the top range for your bid so you show your ♥K.

That was apparently the missing link for partner, he now says 3NT.

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7
 ♥ Q 5
 ♦ 9 5 3 2
 ♣ A K J 5 3

♠ K Q 10 9 3 2

♥ 8 4 2

♦ A 7

♣ 9 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6 4
 ♥ J 10 9 6 3
 ♦ Q 10 8 4
 ♣ Q 7

♠ A 8 5

♥ A K 7

♦ K J 6

♣ 10 8 6 4

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	2 ♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3 ♦	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♥ J			

The bidding has been as shown.

You might just try 4♠. Of course if partner has a minimum Weak Jump Overcall that will get you much too high. A better approach is to ask for more information from partner. The bid that asks is 2NT. Partner replies 3♦.

Partner's 3♦ bid tells you two things. One, he is in the top half of his 6-11 point range. Two, he has a high card (Ace or King) in ♦s. When you construct a hand for him which contains 6 pretty good ♠s and the ♦A you come up with a hand which will probably make game. Bid 4♠.